

# Pietro Pellerito

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Citizenship: USA

## Fields of Interest

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Labor, Public, Economics of Education

## Education

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Ph.D. Economics, University of Notre Dame                          | May 2027 (exp.) |
| M.A. Economics, University of Notre Dame                           | July 2022       |
| B.S. Applied Mathematics, Kettering University (Minor - Economics) | June 2021       |

## Job Market Paper

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“Breaking Boundaries: Competitive Effects of Inter-District School Choice”

**Abstract:** Inter-district school choice (IDSC) allows students to attend public schools outside their residential districts and may improve educational quality by exposing districts to enrollment pressure. I test this claim empirically by exploiting an unanticipated Indiana funding reform that eliminated transfer tuition in 2010, sharply reducing household participation costs. Using statewide student-level administrative data, I estimate a continuous difference-in-differences model where school districts’ enrollment-threat exposure is constructed from pre-policy achievement gaps with neighboring districts. A one-standard-deviation increase in exposure produces a net enrollment loss through transfer students equal to 2.06 percent of district enrollment, while reducing the initial value-added gap between lower- and higher-exposure districts by 5.3 percent. Quality gains are concentrated in elementary grades. Consistent with stronger incentives from enrollment losses, competitive effects are larger in smaller, geographically compact districts, where losses are harder to absorb and alternatives are more accessible. These findings identify enrollment incentives as a channel through which reducing barriers to IDSC can reduce educational inequality.

## Working Papers

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“Staying Connected: Experimental Effects of Weekly Text Messages in an Adult High School”  
with Patrick Turner and Alberto Ortega

## Selected Works in Progress

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“Firm Behavior to Dual Minimum Wage Policies” – with Tim Spilde  
“Do ILEARN More? Retention, Resources, and Future Academic Attainment”

## Research Experience

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|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Research Assistant to Patrick Turner, University of Notre Dame | 2024–2026 |
| Research Assistant to Niharika Singh, University of Notre Dame | 2023–2024 |
| Research Assistant to Petros Ioannatos, Kettering University   | 2020      |

## Teaching Experience

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Instructor, University of Notre Dame, Principles of Microeconomics         | 2024 |
| Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame, LP Statistics for Economics  | 2023 |
| Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame, Principles of Microeconomics | 2022 |
| Supplemental Instructor, Kettering University, Microeconomics I            | 2019 |
| Supplemental Instructor, Kettering University, Calculus II                 | 2018 |

## Fellowships, Awards, and Affiliations

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| Notre Dame Program for Interdisciplinary Education Research (PIER) | 2023–2027 |
| Awarded annual \$2,500 research stipend                            |           |
| Graduate Student Research Award                                    | 2024      |
| Totaled \$4,000                                                    |           |
| U.S. Census Bureau Special Sworn Status                            |           |
| Restricted-use data access through Chicago RDC                     |           |
| Wilson Sheehan Lab for Economic Opportunities Research Affiliate   | 2026–2027 |

## Presentations

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**2026** - Notre Dame Applied Micro Brown Bag; Notre Dame Graduate Student Seminar; Association for Education Finance and Policy; Leuven Economics of Education Research; Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics; MidSouth Education Policy (Scheduled); Southern Economic Association (Scheduled); Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (Scheduled)

**2025** - Notre Dame Applied Micro Brown Bag; Notre Dame Graduate Student Seminar; MidSouth Education Policy; Midwest Sociology of Education Conference

## Work Experience

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|----------------------------------------|-----------|
| Actuarial Intern, Willis Towers Watson | 2018–2020 |
| Purchasing Assistant, LEER Corporation | 2017–2018 |

## Attributes and Skills

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**Computational Skills:** Stata, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Excel (Advanced) Matlab, Python, SPSS (proficient)

**Applied Methods:** RCT design, causal inference methods, value-added estimation, event studies

**Federal Access, Credentials, & Compliance:** U.S Census Bureau Special Sward Status, Restricted-Use Federal Data Authorization

## References

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|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Jim Sullivan</b> (Chair) | <b>Jeffrey Denning</b>               | <b>Patrick Turner</b>             |
| Professor of Economics      | Associate Professor of Public Policy | Assistant Proffessor of Economics |
| University of Notre Dame    | University of Texas                  | University of Notre Dame          |
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